

SPECIALIZED AND MULTIPURPOSE ARMS

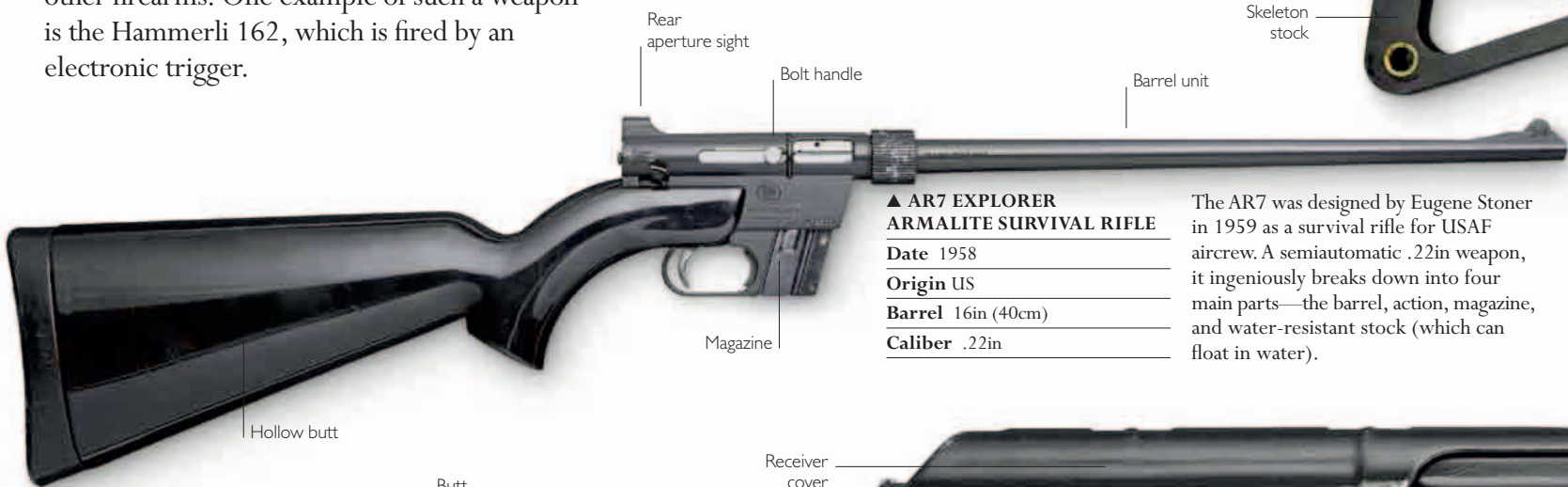
Multipurpose firearms have existed since the 17th century, when pistols and long arms were used for launching grenades for the first time. What has changed over the intervening centuries is the lethality of those projectiles and the need to launch them farther to protect the firer. Other specialized arms were built ruggedly for survival in the event of aircraft crashes, or other similar incidents where a virtually indestructible firearm might be needed. Precision target shooting also demands arms specifically designed for that purpose, and often they bear little resemblance to other firearms. One example of such a weapon is the Hammerli 162, which is fired by an electronic trigger.



▲ **M59/66 WITH GRENADE-LAUNCHER**

Date	1949
Origin	Soviet Union
Barrel	20in (50.8cm)
Caliber	7.62 × 39mm
Grenade range	330ft (100m)
Grenade type	Antitank

This was the Red Army’s standard antitank grenade launcher during the 1950s. Mounted on the self-loading M59/66 assault rifle, it employed an overpowered blank cartridge to launch a grenade. While effective, it proved unpopular due to the disastrous effect of mistakenly chambering a regular live round while the grenade is still attached.



▲ **AR7 EXPLORER ARMALITE SURVIVAL RIFLE**

Date	1958
Origin	US
Barrel	16in (40cm)
Caliber	.22in

The AR7 was designed by Eugene Stoner in 1959 as a survival rifle for USAF aircrew. A semiautomatic .22in weapon, it ingeniously breaks down into four main parts—the barrel, action, magazine, and water-resistant stock (which can float in water).



◀ **HECKLER AND KOCH MP5A5**

Date	1966
Origin	Germany
Barrel	8¾in (22.5cm)
Caliber	9mm Parabellum
Grenade range	450ft (137m)
Grenade type	Antipersonnel

The MP5A5 is a plastic-stock version of the MP5 (see p.257). Here the multipurpose arm is featured in combination with a mounted grenade-launcher built by the British company ISTEK.



Grenade-launcher safety catch

Safety catch and rate-of-fire selector